

Useful insects

Here are some other ways that insects are useful to us.



Red food dye: this food colouring is made from the bodies of scale insects.



Silk: believe it or not, the silk you wear is made by silk-moth caterpillars!



Honey: if there were no bees in the world, we would have no honey.



Food: in many cultures around the world, insects such as grubs are a nutritious meal.

Pest control

Sometimes insects, such as aphids, eat huge amounts of our crops. The best way to get rid of them is to introduce another insect that likes to eat them. Ladybirds are often used for aphid pest control.

Introducing insects that eat other insects is called biological pest control.

Ladybird

Aphid

Aphids breed so quickly that it is difficult to control them.

As old as an insect

We know that insects existed 40 million years ago because some were trapped in a tree resin called amber, which hardened and preserved them.



Turn and learn

Beetles:
pp. 120-121
Bees:
pp. 122-123